

Steel Valley Trail looks to finish 'missing link'

By Stacy Lee
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The Great Allegheny Passage's mile-long "missing link" in the Steel Valley could be on the way to being connected.

Steel Valley Trail representatives will request 21½ linear feet from Munhall borough and seek permission to remove landscaping in an area where the next section of the Great Allegheny Passage will go.

"The Steel Valley Trail council is working on building the trail from the Glenwood Bridge to McKeesport," Steel Valley Trail Council vice president Hannah Hardy said. "From McKeesport, we go through the Tenth Ward through Glassport and connect to the Montour Trail in Clairton."

She said the area is the final missing link in the Great Allegheny Passage.

"The Great Allegheny Passage is going to connect Pittsburgh Point State Park all the way to Cumberland, Md.," Hardy said.

"That's 150 miles. Then we hook up in Cumberland, Md. to the C&O Canal, which is already finished, going all the way to Washington, D.C."

Jack Paulik, project manager for Regional Trail Corp., said three major bridges Whitaker, Port Perry and Riverton bridges will be constructed by the end of this year or the beginning of next year.

"In completing those, plus the Coke Gas Pipeline section, we will have trail up to the east Waterfront complete from there to D.C.," he said.

"That brings us right up to the Marcegaglia property. Going in front of the Marcegaglia property would then take us to the Waterfront property where the trail is in front of the Waterfront."

Paulik said the new trail would be right along E. Waterfront Drive, between the fence and the road encroaching on the landscaping there. He said 21½ linear feet of Munhall borough property is needed for the trail.

Earlier this month, Munhall council president Joseph Ballas said Hardy and Paulik would first need to propose the right-of-way request to the borough's planning commission, which meets the second Wednesday of every month, and it will make a recommendation to council.

"I don't think we're going to stand in the way of the trail," Councilman Dan Lloyd said.

"Hopefully, you can go to planning and come back here next month," Councilman Bernie Shields said.

Another Steel Valley link has Allegheny County Executive Dan Onorato working to help the Steel Valley Trail Council in negotiations with Sandcastle in West Homestead, because the trail would go through its property.

Stacy Lee can be reached at slee@dailynewsemail.com or 412-664-9161.

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